the begs was perhaps not very true. Babur could sense that Shahbāz was unaware of them until they drew closer. And when he came to know this, he fled into the fort. Babur has recounted this experience in the *Baburnama* as follows:[*]

> It often happens so! Once having said, 'The enemy is on guard!' it is easily fancied true, and the chance of action is lost. In short, the experience of such things is that no effort or exertion must be omitted once the chance for action comes. After-repentance is useless.

There was a little fighting around the fort at the dawn and no serious attacks took place.

For the sake of foraging, Babur and his men moved from Nū-kīnt towards the hills in the direction of Bīshkhārān. Shahbāz Qārlūq saw this as an opportunity, and he abandoned Nū-kīnt, making a return to Kāsān. Babur occupied Nū-kīnt effortlessly.

Then began Babur's campaigns. Following that flightless victory, Babur's army overran almost all the sides and quarters, the villages of Akhsī and Kāsān. Finally, Shahbāz and Long Ḥasan's adopted son, Mīrīm came out of Kāsān to give a fight only to see a humiliating defeat with the latter's death.

The Businesses of Pāp

Akhsī had a strong fort named Pāp, whose people harboured some plans. They immediately sent out a representative to Babur who conveyed people's desire to join his side. Accordingly, in return, Babur sent Sayyid Qāsim with a few brave men to occupy the fort. Sayyid Qāsim was a noble and administrator in Babur's court. He is particularly known for serving as the wazir (chief minister) and most trusted advisor under Babur's son, Humayun. He would be instrumental in helping Humayun consolidate his rule and administer the empire during the most challenging phase.

They crossed the river, reaching the opposite side of the upper villages of Akhsī and barged directly into Pāp. Soon afterwards, Sayyid Qāsim did an astonishing thing.

There came a time when Shaikh Bāyazīd in Akhsī, Ibrāhīm Chāpūk ṭaghāī, Aḥmad-of-qāsim Kohbur, and Qāsim Khitika Arghūn were attached with around 200 serviceable warriors and instructed to surprise Pāp on a